CLÍNICA DENTAL implantdent

POST-OPERATIVE INSTRUCTIONS

After your dental implant surgery

Follow these guidelines for good healing and successful integration of your implant.

Most patients recover without complications within a few days. Please read this sheet carefully and keep it: it explains what to do, what is normal to feel and when to contact us.

Caring for yourself at home

1 Take your medication as prescribed

Stick to the doses and times. If you have been prescribed an antibiotic, finish the full course even if you feel well. Take the first painkiller before the anaesthetic wears off. Do not stop or change any medication without asking us.

2 Gauze and bleeding

Bite firmly and steadily on the gauze for 30–60 minutes. If it keeps bleeding, replace it with a clean gauze, ideally moistened, and repeat. Pink-tinged saliva for 1–2 days is normal.

3 Cold on the area (first 48 h)

Apply cold to the outside of your face over the treated area: 15–20 minutes on, 15–20 minutes off. Always wrap ice in a cloth, never directly on the skin. Do not apply heat during these days.

4 What to eat

Wait until the numbness wears off. First days: soft, cold or lukewarm food (yoghurt, purées, soups, smoothies, eggs, fish). Avoid hot, hard, crunchy or spicy food, or food with seeds. Chew on the other side and drink plenty of water.

5 Do not spit or rinse (24 h)

Spitting, rinsing hard or drinking through a straw can dislodge the blood clot and restart bleeding. Swallow your saliva normally. From the next day, rinse gently with the prescribed mouthwash, without swishing hard.

6 No smoking, no alcohol

Smoking (including vaping) slows healing and is one of the main causes of implant failure: avoid it for at least 2 weeks — even better, use this as a chance to quit. No alcohol while taking your medication.

7 Oral hygiene

Brush your other teeth from that same night with a soft toothbrush, taking great care near the surgical area. Do not touch the wound with your tongue or fingers, or pull your lip to look at it. If you wear a denture, use it only as we have told you.

8 Rest

Rest on the day of surgery. Avoid sport, heavy lifting and bending over for 3–4 days. Sleep with your head slightly raised (two pillows) to reduce swelling.

If you had a sinus lift: do not blow your nose, sneeze with your mouth open and avoid flying or diving until we tell you it is safe.

✓ This is normal and part of healing

These reactions are expected and improve day by day. There is no need to worry.

✓ Swelling
Increases over the first 48–72 h, then goes down gradually.

✓ Bruising
On the cheek, chin or neck. It turns from purple to yellow and fades in 1–2 weeks.

✓ Pain
Moderate discomfort for the first 2–3 days, controlled with medication.

✓ Mild fever
A slight temperature (below 38 °C) during the first 24–48 h.

✓ Pink saliva
Light oozing or blood-tinged saliva for 1–2 days.

✓ Stiffness
Difficulty opening your mouth, dry lips or a mild sore throat for a few days.

Call us if...

- Bleeding does not stop after 1 hour of firm pressure on gauze.
- Pain or swelling get worse from day 3 instead of better, or pain is not relieved by medication.
- You have a temperature of 38 °C or higher, or it lasts more than 2 days.
- You notice a bad taste, bad smell or pus in the area.
- Your lip, chin or tongue is still numb the next day.
- The implant or healing cap feels loose or moves.
- The medication causes a rash, itching, nausea or vomiting.

Seek emergency care or call 112 if...

- You have difficulty breathing or swallowing.
- Swelling grows quickly and spreads to the eye, neck or under the tongue.
- Bleeding is heavy and you cannot control it.
- You have a high fever (39 °C or more) with chills or feel generally very unwell.
- Your lips, tongue or face swell, with hives or dizziness (possible severe allergy).

EMERGENCIES **112**

Outside our opening hours, don't wait: go to the emergency department.

CLINIC PHONE _____ NEXT CHECK-UP / STITCH REMOVAL _____

General post-operative guidelines. If your dentist has given you different instructions, always follow your dentist's instructions.